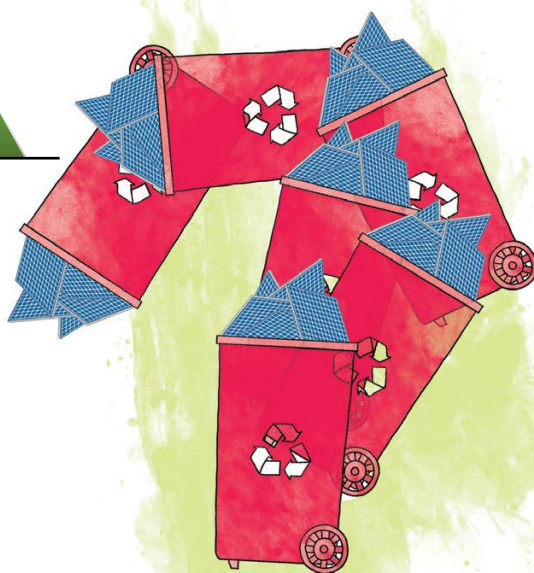


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BOOST R&D INVESTMENT IN FUTURE BATTERY TECH

► India is rapidly increasing investment in battery storage to ensure round-the-clock availability of renewable power. There has been record tendering for battery storage facilities but dependence on China for batteries, cells and other equipment is very high.

44 | The government must give a push to R&D in future battery technology to become self-dependent in this vital sector, keeping in mind supply chain challenges from geopolitical disruptions.



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ADDRESS RENEWABLE WASTE CHALLENGE

► As per the International Renewable Energy Agency, by 2050, global solar panel waste could reach 78 million metric tonnes—the equivalent of more than 20,000 fully loaded Boeing 747 jets. In India, the cumulative solar waste from both existing and new capacity deployment between FY24 and FY30 is estimated at 600 kilotonnes. There is a need for effective recycling strategies—database maintenance, incentivising recyclers and creating a market for solar recycling—to address this challenge.

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CLIMATE RESILIENT URBAN PLANNING

► Mumbai's streets flood every monsoon, flash floods destroy infrastructure in hill states, hydropower projects collapse due to cloud bursts and manual productivity is repeatedly affected by rising temperatures. These are just some of the visible impacts of global warming that India is already witnessing. However, urban planning doesn't account for climate resilience. India should have climate-resilient city certification with performance-based incentives for climate-ready urban planning.

